

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Reading • English • Literature • Languages • Graphic design • Technology • Creative writing



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS A degree is required; English is preferred by some employers, but degrees in other subjects are useful for specialized publishing.



LIFESTYLE Editors in full-time jobs keep regular office hours, but evening and weekend work is often required, especially if freelancing.



LOCATION Editors are largely office- or home-based. Occasional travel to trade shows—sometimes overseas—or meetings may be required.



THE REALITIES Editors must put in long hours of meticulous editorial work. Schedules can be demanding, especially if working on multiple projects.



FICTION EDITOR Works with the author of a novel or short story to prepare the manuscript for publication. Assesses the author's work, suggests changes to make the text more engaging, corrects errors, and may advise on marketing and production.



NON-FICTION EDITOR Develops, commissions, and checks content for non-fiction books, such as biographies, histories, and cookery, travel, or fitness books. Non-fiction editors may liaise with subject specialists to consult on the text.



REFERENCE EDITOR

Plans, commissions, and ensures the accuracy of text for a range of reference works, such as dictionaries, encyclopedias, directories, and academic or scientific works.



ACADEMIC JOURNAL EDITOR Prepares scholarly or scientific articles for publication and distribution to academics and researchers. Ensures that articles are read and validated by expert consultants.



ONLINE EDITOR Sources, edits, and collates text and imagery for publishing on websites. Online editors are trained in specialized web-design and editing software.

SKILLS GUIDE



Excellent verbal and written skills to express themes, ideas, and concepts clearly to the reader.



Strong team-working skills for liaising with authors, designers, and other publishing departments.



A creative flair, critiquing skills, and commercial awareness to improve and refine a publication.



Flexibility and adaptability, as publishing schedules may be revised at short notice.



Good organizational skills, since workloads may be heavy and involve several projects at once.